

## INFORMATION - Oral hygiene tips

### Periodontal disease

#### 1. Definition

The term periodontal disease is used to describe diseases affecting the tissues that support the teeth, known as the periodontium.

When periodontal disease is confined to the gums, it's called gingivitis. When it affects the entire periodontium, it's called periodontitis. The resulting bone loss is called alveolysis.

Both gingivitis and periodontitis are caused by plaque, a microbial community that includes bacteria, viruses, protozoa and yeasts.

It is the leading cause of tooth loss, ahead of cavities.

#### 2. Symptoms :

- Dental pain
- Visible signs of gingivitis: red, smooth, swollen gums that bleed easily on contact, sometimes even spontaneously.
- Visible signs of periodontitis: "loosening" of the teeth, i.e. the supporting bone loses height and the tooth appears longer. Tooth mobility. This is often the most worrying sign. Tooth hypersensitivity at tooth necks, due to root exposure.

#### 3. Case management

- Oral and dental hygiene  
Periodontal disease can be prevented by carefully removing plaque twice a day, for at least three minutes, using a soft toothbrush.
- In case of gingivitis or periodontitis: indometacin cp25 mg 2x1cp/day for 5days combined with amoxycillin gel 500 mg 2x2gel/day for 7days  
If is no improvementrefer to district hospital.

Nb :

Discourage sharing your toothbrush

The vast majority of drugs are not recommended for pregnant women, especially anti-inflammatory drugs such as ibuprofen.